Millen Woods School Council
November 13, 2024 Meeting Minutes

Welcome & Introductions: Ashley

- Meeting called to order at 6:33
- Motion to approve agenda – Sarah N & Kristen
- Motion to approve October 2024 minutes – Rachel

Admin Report: Karen

- Volleyball intramurals have started. Grade 6 travel team has been formed – no cuts were made, and everyone gets the opportunity to play a portion of the games
- Mme Kazemzadeh will be taking a temporary position with ETFO starting in December until the end of June. The position is a "member mobilizer" and involves advocacy for students and public education. Mme K will stay on until her position can be filled with an LTO.
- CBC Radio Contest submission was recorded today – the whole school came together to perform one indigenous song.
- Mme Marschuetz is retiring at the winter break. A permanent experienced French Immersion teacher has been hired to start in January.
- Safe Caring and Inclusive Schools committee is up and running. The mandate is to raise awareness for the various days of recognition through posters & announcements and facilitate events throughout the year around Indigenous learning.
- Ministry Screening happened in K – Grade 2 classes. The screening assesses the reading program. Results will be shared with parents in the next few weeks. The screening happens 2-3 times per year and it is common for students to not pass the first screening as it happens early in the year and the teachers haven't had a chance to teach the specific skills at the time of the screening. Teachers will be providing contextual information to parents to help them interpret the results. The screening will be coming for grades 3-6 in the future but the teachers are working to understand the program now so that they can be prepared to help students succeed

Finance Report: Raj

- Cash inflows: $978 for popcorn sales and $468 for chocolate fundraiser
- Cash outflows: $408 for popcorn purchases
- Ending cash balance is $55,530 at the end of October

Kindie Playground Status Update: Karen

- The Board's procurement department has been busy so the RFP has not yet been issued but is planned to be issued before the holiday break, still hoping for a Spring 2025 installation
- Update on timing to come once available

PRO Grant: Karen/Ashley

- We are looking at the potential to combine the PIC and PRO grants for this year
- The format will be an evening event for children and families with an arts focus (in the past we have done ESQ stem night or guest speakers)
- ArtShine has a variety of options we can use for this year's event:
    - Paint Night instructor-led project - $250/instructor, and either the school provides materials or $18.75 per person for materials provided by ArtShine
    - Booths setup – less structured event, students can stop by various booths and make projects as they choose. $300+HST per booth (1 project, 1 instructor)
- Questions raised by Council: Do we know the booth size (number of kids that could visit each one)? Is a discount available for multiple booths and instructors? Does the $300 booth fee include

materials? What is the estimated capacity and throughput for the booth setup? Do they have examples of projects from the booth format?

Action item: Ashley is to reach out to ArtShine with the above questions

- Can we run our own event similar to the booth idea – come up with a few projects to be run by volunteers in 4 or 5 classrooms, the school would source the materials using PRO grant funds, and volunteers would demonstrate the project and have a finished sample.
- Council discussed looking at Pinterest or ArtShine website for project inspiration. Do we know high school students looking for volunteer hours who would like to demo a project?

Action item: Steph and Ashley had leads on some teens who may be interested in this project
Council to come up with ideas on projects
Add discussion item to December's agenda

- We still have time before the PRO grant application is available. We can draft the application based on an art night to be determined. The timing is expected to be March or April.

Snack & Lunch Program Update: Karen/Ashley

- ESNS has switched pizza day back to Dominos permanently
- Apple program is going well, getting lots of apple donations from families
- The popcorn program is going well, new flavours were ordered this fall and Ashley is looking for feedback from kids on which ones they want to see continue
- ESNS feedback:
    - Tacos and burritos are a big hit this year
    - We need to provide reminders to parents to send cutlery and a plastic bag for anything to come home, especially on Boston Pizza days
    - Some families have expressed concerns with equity around the ESNS lunch days, however, the ESNS fundraiser makes up a significant portion of the council's budget and is necessary to provide enrichment opportunities to all students in the school. Discussion was had on some other alternatives that we could explore such as BP does veggies & dip, does the Mexican option have a taco salad?

Action item: Karen to set up reminder email through SchoolDay re: cutlery and Ziploc bags
Action item: Ashley to enquire with the ESNS rep if a taco salad option is available if we can add veggies & dip for the Boston Pizza days, and if a salad option is available from Dominos.

Cold Weather Clothing Drive Results: Steph

- Went very well, Forest Hill Public School picked everything up – 33 coats, 25 snow pants, 19 shoes, and 1 bag of winter accessories. They were very appreciative of the donations.

Fundraising Update: Ashley

- Esta Chocolates Fundraiser
    - 150 boxes sold so far, our goal is 330 to hit our fundraising goal – please spread the word
    - The timing is close to Halloween which may deter some families from wanting to order more chocolate, so consider for next year to do either earlier or later in the year. We are also competing with all the sports teams' fundraisers right now
- Dance A Thon
    - Ideas for new concepts were discussed. We have some time to decide but if we want to stay with the old format we need time to book the DJ.
    - Old format: DJ set up in the gym, classes had 30-minute blocks to dance in the gym, with an alternative activity set up in the gym next door for older grades who are not as interested

in the dancing, photo booth set up in the library for $2/photo; donations not mandatory but traditionally has done well
    - An idea was discussed for this year – each class can come up with a dance to perform during dance a thon, we could record the dances and then show videos later. Teachers would work with the classes to come up with and practice the dance during the dance unit

Action item: Add to December agenda to continue discussing ideas

Winter Wonderland Update: Kristen

- Subcommittee (Daniela, Sarah, Pradeep, Emily, Rachel, Rebecca, Kristen) has met and is brainstorming ideas. Dominos pizza orders for whole pizzas, hot chocolate bar, and photo booth
- Entertainment options are being considered – we are looking for something artistic (dance, singing performance). Discussed the desire to make it interactive and engaging for students. Arts Abound and Star Performance Academy have been approached to see if any of their older students would like to perform.
- Coffee was discussed – in the past, it has been donated but not necessarily drunk and results in waste. Considering doing a tea station instead, Daniela has a carafe that can be used for hot water. Suggest asking parents to bring reusable mugs.
- Mural project for students and families to colour/create during the event – Daniela has a large paper roll
- Toonie toss to be donated to charity instead of the food bank donations from prior years

School Photos Discussion: Karen

- Karen is meeting with the photo companies, will bring the data and then we can make a decision
- Feedback on Edge has been great
- Class photos – Council asked whether we can move composite photos up earlier in the year so that families have the class photo available earlier to see their students' classmates.

Action item: Karen to reach out to Edge to ask about the timing of composite photos
Karen to reach out to Edge to ask about sibling photos
When class photos are distributed, an email should go on SchoolDay so parents know to check backpacks

Math and Literacy: Karen

- Karen gave a presentation on the Board's initiatives towards literacy, including the BIEP goals, MAAP math plan, and SLMYP literacy plan. These plans cover goals to support students in many areas including math, literacy, sovereignty human rights and equity, mental health well-being and engagement
- The Board website has information on each of the plans and links will be shared
- The BIEP is a board-wide plan. Millen students are already meeting the targets established in the BIEP based on our EQAO results.
- Teachers have been undergoing a lot of learning to implement these plans. Millen is in year 2 of a multi-year plan.
- Karen gave a demonstration of Heggerty literacy teaching. Council performed very well 😊
- Math presentation to be given by Karen next month
- Strong Start program is in place, started a bit later than usual due to a change in materials this year. We have many enthusiastic parent and grandparent volunteers.

Adjournment: Ashley

- Meeting adjourned at 8:01

Next meeting: December 11th at 6:30 in person with virtual link

MILLEN WOODS SCHOOL COUNCIL
ATTENDANCE SHEET FOR November 13, 2024

#	Name	Position	Email	Initial for Attendance
1.	Karen Grant-O'Grady	Principal	karen_grantogrady@wrdsb.ca	KGO
2.	Ashley Feeney	Co-Chair	ashleylfeeney@gmail.com	AF
3.	Emily Lutz	Co-Chair	emilywyss@gmail.com	Regrets
4.	Erin Evans	Co-Secretary	erinnfranklin@gmail.com	EE
5.	Steph Honour	Co-Secretary	stephaniemhonour@gmail.com	SH
6.	Raj Pancha	Treasurer	Rajathepan@hotmail.com	RP
7.	Sarah Nickel	Co-Communications Officer	nickelsarahm@gmail.com	SN
8.	Rachel Sarchielli	Co-Communications Officer	sarchrachel@gmail.com	RS
9.	Jake Billo	Technology Officer	jake@billo.ca	JB
10.	Colleen Araya	Volunteer Coordinator	colleenmw@hotmail.com	Regrets
11.	Dan Collens	Voting	dan.collens@gmail.com	DC
12.	Pradeep Chandran	Voting	pradeep24s@gmail.com	PC
13.	Kristen Smith	Voting	kj_martin@hotmail.com	KS
14.	Daniella Cross-Henderson	Voting	daniellacross@gmail.com	online
15.	Julia Klein	Voting	julia.kleinhb@gmail.com	Regrets
16.	Maryam Elsabagh	Voting	maryam_rashad@hotmail.com	
17.	Nicolas Mellet	Voting	nicolas.mellet@net.com	NM
18.	Sandra Ribes	Voting	mrs.s.ribes@gmail.com	SR
19.	Sarah Boss	Non-Voting	Slouboss@gmail.com	
20.	Hamed Hashemi	Non-Voting	s.h.hashemi65@gmail.com	
21.	Meaghan McGloin	Non-Voting	meaghan.mcgloin@gmail.com	online
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Millen Woods Public School
School Council
Monthly Report 2024/25

	September	October	November	December	January	February	March	April	May	June	September	YTD totals	Budget 2023/2024	
Opening Balance School Council Account	26,974.56	28,730.62	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63	29,768.63		
Opening Balance WEFI Account	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64	25,760.64		
Fundraising Activities (Revenue)														
WEFI Donations												0.00	0.00	
ESNS (Lunches - Tuesday, Thursday, 1 Friday a month)	2,673.65											2,673.65	5,500.00	
Mabel's Labels (ongoing)	128.40											128.40	100.00	
TruEarth (ongoing)												0.00	0.00	
Factory Shoes (ongoing)												0.00	300.00	
Meet the Community (Sept)												0.00	200.00	Food Trucks
Fall Fundraiser (Oct) - Esta Chocolates		468.00										468.00	1,000.00	
Winter Wonderland (January)												0.00	200.00	Pizza Sales
Winter Fundraiser (March)												0.00	5,000.00	Dance-a-thon?
Movie Night (April)												0.00	0.00	
Year-End Social & Spring Fundraiser (June 11)												0.00	500.00	
Popcorn Sales	694.00	978.00										1,672.00	6,400.00	
Ice Cream Sandwich Sales												0.00	0.00	
HST Rebates												0.00	0.00	
Fundraising Activities total (School Account)	**3,496.05**	**1,446.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**4,942.05**	
Fundraising Activities total (WEFI)	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	
Fundraising Total (both accounts)	**$3,496.05**	**$1,446.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$0.00**	**$4,942.05**	**19,200.00**
Expenses														
General Administration												0.00	500.00	
Home & Classroom reading												0.00	1,500.00	
Grade 6 Graduation												0.00	200.00	
Playground bins (13 classes x $75)	$720.93											720.93	500.00	refill in spring 2025
Musical Instruments Reserve												0.00	200.00	piano tuning
Extracurricular Clubs												0.00	0.00	
Playground Maintenance												0.00	0.00	
Donation to another School												0.00	0.00	
Enrichment - School Trips/Transportation	$509.53											509.53	2,500.00	allocated $200/class
Enrichment - School Events or Resources												0.00	5,000.00	
Dance-a-thon												0.00	1,000.00	DJ and photobooth
Area Track Meet Bussing	$509.53											509.53	500.00	
Popcorn Purchase		407.99										407.99	2,500.00	
Student Subsides												0.00	100.00	
Athletics Requests												0.00	500.00	carry year over year
Grounds Maintenance (plants, mulch, garden supplies)												0.00	750.00	
Winter Wonderland												0.00	1,200.00	
Playground Improvement												0.00	1,500.00	carry year over year ... Gaga Ball Pit $3000
Expenses total	**1,739.99**	**407.99**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**0.00**	**2,147.98**	**18,450.00**
Ending Balance School Council Account	**28,730.62**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	**29,768.63**	
Ending Balance WEFI Account	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	**25,760.64**	
Total Balance	**$54,491.26**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**$55,529.27**	**750.00**	